



Farmville shutting down

Popular FaceBook game Farmville is shutting for good by the end of this year.
<http://dgit.in/oct20-11>



Android Auto

Android Auto is Google Map's new dedicated car mode, with its own UI.
<http://dgit.in/oct20-12>



Simplified opening procedure

Underneath the stretchy watchband of the Apple Watch Series 6, you can spot the new model number – A2376. The procedure of opening up this new model has also been largely simplified due to the absence of the Touch Force gasket and the watch actually opens up sideways like a book! The easier opening procedure is a welcome change, however, it comes at the expense of the nifty pressure-sensitive Touch Force technology, which is now extinct on Apple Watches.



The sensor array

With the new Apple Watch Series 6, you get an updated sensor array that is capable of measuring heart rate, ECG, and even blood oxygen levels. The sensor array is fused to the bottom and the pulse oximeter shines green, red, and infrared light on your skin. A photodiode on the sensor measures how the lights bounce back and the sensor can gauge how oxygenated your blood is, which is particularly useful during the COVID-19 pandemic.



Moderately easy-to-replace display

Sporting an LTPO OLED Retina display which is optimised for always-on functionality, this newer, and brighter display on the Series 5 has fewer display connectors to disconnect as compared to previous models. The NFC cable is routed through a display-side jumper and there's merely one grounding cable, which simplifies display repairs.



Larger taptic engine

The taptic engine on the Watch Series 6 is trapped by tiny tri-point screws which can be slightly difficult to remove. Also, the taptic engine on this new model is noticeably larger than the one on the Series 5 Watch. Interestingly, it is made using 100 percent recycled rare earth metals and tungsten this time around, which is commendable.



The brains of the watch

With some major components out of the way, the 64-bit dual-core Apple S6 SiP (System in Package) can now be extracted. However, there's an intricate maze of cables and screws that has to be navigated through first. This Watch comes with a few conventional ICs and a Skyworks Chip as well. Moving on from the SiP, the Watch's frame itself has a modified footprint. This modified case and the lack of Force Touch has resulted in the Watch Series 6 being slightly slimmer than its predecessor.



Easily replaceable battery

In order to safely replace the battery, it must first be disconnected properly. The battery connector is located under the powerhouse itself, but a simple flick from an opening pick disconnects it. The 4mm Watch Series 6 is rated at 1.17 Wh, which is a slight increase (3.4 percent increase) over its predecessor, but still doesn't match up the Galaxy Watch 3's 1.3 Wh.